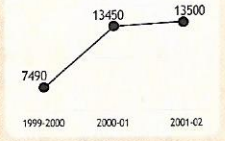
15 REDINGTON (INDIA) LTD

Rs 13,500 mn (2001-02)

Redington (India) Ltd, founded in 1993, is a leading provider of IT products and services and logistics management serivces. It represents more than 15 leading world-class brands covering product categories like systems, software, peripherals, and components. The company serves more than 500 IT resellers in India covering over 200 cities. The group's operations are highly diversified and cover areas like IT products and services, international trading, property development, textiles manufacturing, etc. The group provides IT products and services in India, US, Singapore, Dubai, Iran, Egypt, Saudi Arabia, Jordan, and Kuwait.



Head Quarters: SPL Guindy House, 95, Mount Road, Chennai-600032. Fax: 91-044-2300940; Ph: 2353313-18; E-mail: vikram.menon@redington.co.in

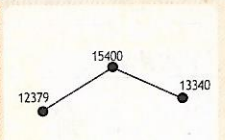
16 HEWLETT PACKARD INDIA LTD

Rs 13,340 mn (2001-02)



BALU DORAISAMY, PRESIDENT

HP India, a wholly-owned subsidiary of HP, was established in 1989. The company's product range includes servers, PCs, printers, workstations, services, etc. HP and Compaq merged in May 2002. HP high-performance servers have been installed in VSNL, TCS, Tata Telecom, etc. The company employs approximately 1000 software professionals at its development facilities in Chennai and Bangalore.



Head Quarters: Chnadiwala Estate, Maa Anandamai Marg, Kalkaji, New Delhi-110019. Website: www.hp.com; Fax: 91-011-6826059; Ph: 6826000; E-mail: info@hpindia.com

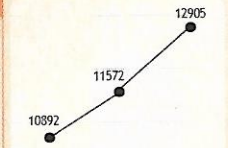
17 SIEMENS LTD

Rs 12,905 mn (2001-02)



JUERGEN SCHUBERT, MD

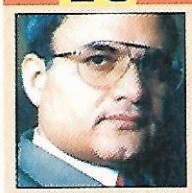
Siemens Ltd manufactures switchboards, switch gears, and different types of motors; assembles railway signaling equipment, X-ray and other electronic equipment; repairs motors, generators, transformers, calorific and measuring instruments, certain household appliances, and marine electrical equipment; and sells products manufactured by the company as well as those of its licencees. The Siemens Group in India is a unique player in the domain of electronics and electrical engineering. Areas of operation include energy, industry, transport, lighting, healthcare, and communications. The company has a wide presence in the country, with 12 manufacturing plants and 19 sales offices. It also has joint ventures in the field of telecom and information technology.



Regd Off: 130, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai-400018. Website: www.siemens.co.in; Fax: 91-022-24987500; Ph: 24987000; E-mail: corp.comm@bom4.siemens.co.in

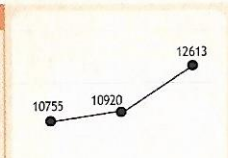
18 HCL INFOSYSTEMS

Rs 12,613 mn (2001-02)



AJAI CHOWDHARY, CHAIRMAN & CEO

HCL Infosystems, an information enabler, offers its clients technology solutions across multiple platforms, focusing on end-to-end solutions and PCs. It has customer service centres in 151 locations, three software export facilities and state-of-the-art manufacturing facilities. It has six overseas business units in USA, UK, Australia, Singapore, Malaysia, and Canada.



Regd Off: 806-808, Siddarth, 96 Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019. Website: www.hclinfosystems.com; Fax: 91-011-4525383; Ph: 4520977; E-mail: cosec@hclinsys.com

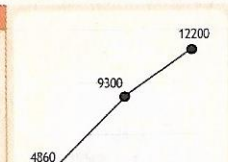
19 INGRAM MICRO INDIA LTD

Rs 12,200 mn (2001-02)



N.Y. PRASAD, COO

As a subsidiary of Ingram Micro Inc., the largest global wholesale provider of technology products and supply-chain management services, Ingram Micro India (formerly Electronic Resources India Ltd) brings to India state-of-the-art information systems. The company is a leading wholesale provider of computer components, systems, printers, peripherals, networking solutions, application software, enterprise storage solutions, and support services. Present in 30 sales offices nationwide, it includes seven regional offices and service support centres at 17 locations.



Head Off: MF 7, Cipet Hostel Road, Thiru-vi-ka Industrial Estate, Ekkaduthangal, Chennai-600097. Website: www.in.ingrammicro.com; Fax: 044-2331751; Tel: 2333071/73/75/77. Email: raghu@imindia.com

***Financial figures mentioned here are estimates from industry reports.*

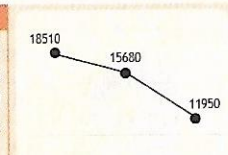
20 BPL LTD

Rs 11,950 mn (2001-02)



AJIT G. NAMBIAR, CMD

BPL Ltd is one of India's leading CTV producers. Other product lines include B&W TV sets, home appliances, DVDs, and audio equipment. The company offers a wide range of TVs catering to various consumer segments. Latest offerings include interactive TVs and multimedia TVs, which combine the latest in TV and computer technology. BPL Ltd, weighed down by Rs 7720 million debt, is working with banks and financial institutions to reschedule its debt and interest obligations.



Regd Off: BPL Works Palakkad, Korda-678007. Website: www.bplworld.com; Fax: 91-0491-535410; Ph: 533241/42

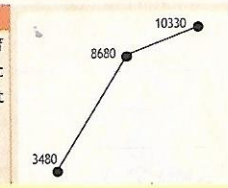
21 CELETRON INDIA

Rs 10,330 mn (2001-02)



M.L. TANDON, CHAIRMAN

Celetron, as a leading electronics manufacturing service provider, has been delivering solutions to cater to the needs of OEM customers. The company's manufacturing operations serve as the foundation for key focus areas. It offers electronic manufacturing services/circuits (PCAs, PCBs, flex circuits, and chips-on-board), power conversion solutions, low-cost memory solutions, and radio frequency identification solutions for a broad range of applications.



Regd Off: Unit No 9, SDF-I, SEEPZ, Andheri (East), Mumabi-400096. Website: www.celetron.com; Fax: 91-022-28291176; Ph: 28291919/02

Industry News

Corporate news including new ventures and collaborations as well as new appointments

IT hardware on recovery path

Manufacturers' Association of Information Technology (MAIT) has announced the findings of its IT industry performance review for the quarter April-June of FY 2002-03.

The desktop PC market grossed 508,000 units—63 per cent of that sold in the first half of 2001-02. The market has shown signs of recovery, with sales in almost all product categories amounting to two-thirds of that sold in the last fiscal. FY 2001-02 had experienced recessionary trend, which had impacted the hardware market. With the buying sentiment in the market improving, PC sales in FY 2002-03 are expected to grow by 15 per cent, crossing 1.9 million units. Fiscal 2001-02 had recorded sales of 1.65 million PC units.

In the first quarter of 2002-03, desktop PCs, notebooks, dot-matrix printers, and laser printers have registered sales of close to two-third of their sales during the first half of 2001-02. Products like servers, inkjet printers, and UPS have registered around 50 per cent of the sales during the first half of 2001-02.

Study on mobile health risks

An Italian research team, headed by Fiorenzo Marinelli at the National Research Council in Bologna, has studied health risks for mobile phone users. In the experiment, cancer cells were found to grow more aggressively when exposed to RF waves. The research team exposed leukaemia cells to RF waves continuously for 48 hours. Initially, the waves killed the cancer cells but subsequently made the surviving tumour cells replicate more rapidly. Longer exposure triggered genes in the surviving cancer cells.

To enable safer mobile phone communication, Professor Yiannis Vardaxoglou, head of the Centre for Mobile Communications Research at Loughborough University, the UK, has used innovative laser technology and supercomputing modelling techniques to develop an antenna that reduces RF mobile phone emissions into the users' body by as much as 85 per cent.

Barrie Foley, head of miniature antenna manufacturer Sarantel, and Yiannis Vardaxoglou, head of the Centre for Mobile Communications Research at Loughborough University, England, in the group's anechoic chamber



Digital decade: 2000-09

On his third visit to India, Bill Gates, chairman of Microsoft Corp., articulated Microsoft's mission of realising potential in the digital decade and its relevance for India.

Mr Gates announced that Microsoft would invest $400 million over the next three years in the areas of education, partnerships, innovation, and localisation in India.

Microsoft's 'Project Shiksha—Empowering the Future' aims at accelerating computer literacy in the country to over 80,000 schoolteachers and 3.5 million students across schools in five years. The company plans to launch Hindi language version of Windows XP and the next version of Microsoft Office (code-named Office 11).

Mobile PCs to overtake desktops?

Intel has revealed that global demand for mobile PCs will exceed that of desktops, with Japan and South Korea leading the trend in Asia. The company is investing $150 million in developing high-speed wireless technology for PCs.

Wi-Fi, a high-speed wireless technology used to connect PCs, laptops, and PDAs to each other and the Internet, will boost the usage of mobile PCs. Nine out of ten mobile PCs would use wireless technology such as the Wi-Fi format by 2004.

Siemens to offer SMS in Hindi

Siemens Mobile is developing Hindi messaging applications for its mobile phones, emulating Nokia that has already incorporated Hindi messaging in its popular models. The company is working closely with Siemens Information Systems, Bangalore, to develop India-centric applications.

Sony to introduce Green procurement system

Sony plans to introduce an environment-friendly procurement system in April 2003.

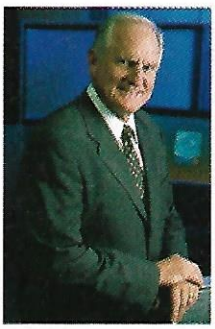
This system is designed to prevent the major electronics makers from purchasing parts and materials that pollute the environment.

Sony is calling on more than 4000 part and material makers worldwide to present to Sony a guarantee certificate for commitment to the environment-friendly supply system. Suppliers will cooperate Sony in establishing a system to control the supply source for environment-friendly parts and materials.

Sony intends to procure parts only from Green partners, plants of which will be audited and certified by Sony. Such Green part makers also will be required to procure materials from makers that are certified by Sony as a Green partner.

Intel developers' forum held in Mumbai

During the first Intel Developer Forum held in Mumbai, Intel's executives called on Indian developers to recognise the opportunities in convergence of computing and communications.



Craig Barrett, CEO, Intel

Craig Barrett, CEO of Intel, revealed that a design team would be established for high-end, 32-bit Intel architecture microprocessor design and development at the Intel India Development Center in Bangalore.

Patrick Gelsinger, VP and CTO, explained how silicon integration would accelerate convergence of the computing and communication industries.

Server modularisation and communication integration embracing standards-based technologies that integrate communication and computing capabilities will provide a significant competitive advantage for corporate IT operations. A modular IT infrastructure that mixes wired and wireless communication capabilities with open and scalable Intel-based servers, networks, and storage will generate lower operating costs and increase flexibility.

Tyco Electronics starts active product manufacturing

Tyco Electronics has started manufacturing Ethernet LAN products at its facility in Bangalore. Initially, the company plans to assemble, test, and market eight product lines from this facility.

The Ethernet LAN products support 10/100Mbps Ethernet and gigabit Ethernet, and can be used in a wide range of applications, including small-office home-office (SOHO), shops, office buildings, professional workgroups, campus, and fibre-to-the-desk and industrial systems.

K.K. Shetty, AMP Netconnect country manager of Tyco Electronics India, said, "With both structured cabling and Ethernet LAN solutions in our product portfolio, we are poised to become the one-stop solution provider for the networking market."

Pinnacle expands network

In a strategic move to increase its market share and penetrate deep in the Indian market, Pinnacle Systems, a leader in digital video content creation tools, has announced its plans to increase presence to over 30 cities and its current premium dealer strength of 35 to 60 by 2003.

Presently, Aditya Infotech is the sole distributor for Pinnacle in India for the home segment. Pinnacle Systems has acquired VOB Computersysteme GmbH that specialises in writable CD and DVD products. With this acquisition it plans to combine the well-recognised technology and talent of VOB with Pinnacle Systems' award-winning consumer video authoring solutions to provide advanced, fully-integrated software suites for writable CD and DVD drives for recording of data, music, and video.

Mentorix expands operations

Mentorix Technologies, a premier global e-Learning solutions company, is foraying into the development and marketing of e-learning products. It has launched four universally deployable e-Learning products. The products include a corporate service conversion tool, an online learning management system, a publishing industry tool, and a product management resource planner. Each of these products would address specific requirements of corporations, publishing houses, and educational institutions.

The company is expanding its Indian operations. It would recruit around 500 professionals by the end of this year. The company is hiring IT professionals, instructional designers, writers, and editors to provide customised end-to-end e-Learning solutions.

Fellowship award for Som Mittal

The Computer Society of India (CSI) has conferred the award of Honorary Fellowship on Som Mittal, president and CEO of Digital GlobalSoft, and vice chairman of NASSCOM, for his significant contributions to the IT industry and spreading the knowledge of computer technology. The award ceremony was held at the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) campus in Bangalore.

An alumnus of IIT-Kanpur and IIM-Ahmedabad, Mr Mittal has rich corporate experience in industries ranging from manufacturing to automobiles to IT. He holds many important positions in state and national apex bodies.

Toshiba India has a new MD

Toshiba India, the wholly owned subsidiary of Japanese electronics giant Toshiba Corp., has appointed Kazuhiko Inamoto as its new managing director. Mr Inamoto, who has been with Toshiba since 1976, will be responsible for bringing the latest advances in Japanese technology and products to the Indian market as well as utilising India's key strength in information technology to enhance the competitiveness of Toshiba products.

Aggarwal is president, IETE

Prof. K.K. Aggarwal, vice chancellor of Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University, Delhi, has taken over as the president of the Institution of Electronics & Telecommunication Engineers (IETE) for the year 2002-2003.



Prof. K.K. Aggarwal

Prof. Aggarwal graduated in electronics and communication engineering from Punjab University and obtained Master's degree in advanced electronics from Kurukshetra University. He has extensively worked in various fields of electronics and computer engineering.

Xilinx appoints Indian representative

Xilinx, a leading programmable logic supplier, has appointed CG-CoreEI Programmable Solutions as its independent sales representative in India.

CG-CoreEI, one of India's leading technology solution providers, offers design services on field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) and application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs) in the areas of telecom, datacom, networking, and digital signal